

Ψευδο-Διονύσιος ὁ Ἀρεοπαγίτης

Pseudo-Dionysius the Areopagite on Divine Names and Celestial Hierarchy

eul_aid: urs

Period: Ὀψιμαρχαία [Late Antique](#)
Dialect: Βυζαντινὴ Χριστιανικὴ [Byzantine Christian](#)
Domain: Θεολογία [Theology](#)
Format: Πραγματεία [Treatise](#)
Affiliation: [Neoplatonist](#)

Pseudo-Dionysius the Areopagite is the name given to an unknown Christian theologian who wrote in Greek, most likely in the late 5th or early 6th century CE. The author deliberately wrote under the pseudonym of Dionysius the Areopagite, an Athenian mentioned in the New Testament as a convert of Saint Paul. This successful disguise led his works to be accepted as genuine apostolic writings for nearly a thousand years.

The author's surviving works consist of four treatises and ten letters. The major treatises are *On the Celestial Hierarchy*, *On the Ecclesiastical Hierarchy*, *On the Divine Names*, and *Mystical Theology*. According to modern scholars, these texts represent a profound synthesis of Christian doctrine with the philosophy of late Neoplatonism.

The author introduced systematic concepts of angelic and church order that became foundational for medieval theology. His approach of "apophatic" or negative theology, which describes God by denying all human attributes, and his writings on mystical union had a deep and lasting influence on both Eastern and Western Christian thought. Because his works were believed to be ancient, they carried immense authority and were extensively commented on by major medieval figures such as Maximus the Confessor, John Scotus Eriugena, and Thomas Aquinas.

The recognition of his true, later date is a result of Renaissance and modern scholarship, but his corpus remains a central subject for the study of Christian mysticism and the interaction between philosophy and theology.

Works (5)

- Ἀποσπάσματα περὶ Θείας Γνώσεως · [Fragments on Divine Knowledge](#) · 27 passages
- Περὶ Θείων Ὄνομάτων · [On Divine Names](#) · 125 passages
- Περὶ τῆς Ἐκκλησιαστικῆς Ἱεραρχίας · [On Ecclesiastical Hierarchy](#) · 70 passages
- Περὶ Μυστικῆς Θεολογίας · [On Mystical Theology](#) · 9 passages
- Περὶ τῆς Οὐρανίας Ἱεραρχίας · [On the Celestial Hierarchy](#) · 53 passages

Other Neoplatonist Authors

- Ἀμελίου Ἐπιστολή · [Amelius Letters](#) · 1 work

- [Ἀμμώνιος ὁ Ἀλεξανδρεὺς · Ammonius of Alexandria Phil](#) · 5 works
- [Δαμάσκιος ὁ Δαμασκηνός · Damascius of Damascus](#) · 7 works
- [Δαβίδ ὁ Ἀνίκητος · David the Invincible](#) · 2 works
- [Δέξιππος ὁ Νεοπλατωνικός · Dexippus the Neoplatonist](#) · 1 work
- [Ἡλίας ὁ Νεοπλατωνικός · Elias the Neoplatonist](#) · 3 works
- [Εὐσέβιος ὁ Μύνδιος · Eusebius of Myndus](#) · 1 work
- [Ἱεροκλῆς ὁ Ἀλεξανδρεὺς · Hierocles of Alexandria](#) · 1 work
- [Ἰάμβλιχος ὁ Ἀνώνυμος · Iamblichus Anonymous](#) · 1 work
- [Ἰάμβλιχος ὁ Χαλκιδεὺς · Iamblichus of Chalcis](#) · 6 works
- [Ἰάμβλιχος ὁ Χαλκιδεὺς · Iamblichus of Chalcis II](#) · 1 work
- [Ἰουλιανὸς ὁ Ἀποστάτης · Julian the Apostate](#) · 20 works